

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – November 2022

Period analysed	March – November 2022
Months carrying comments	May 2022 – Nov 2022
Comments collected	544
Of which substantive	386 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	66 (17.1% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2022. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

544 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **386** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **66 (17.1%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

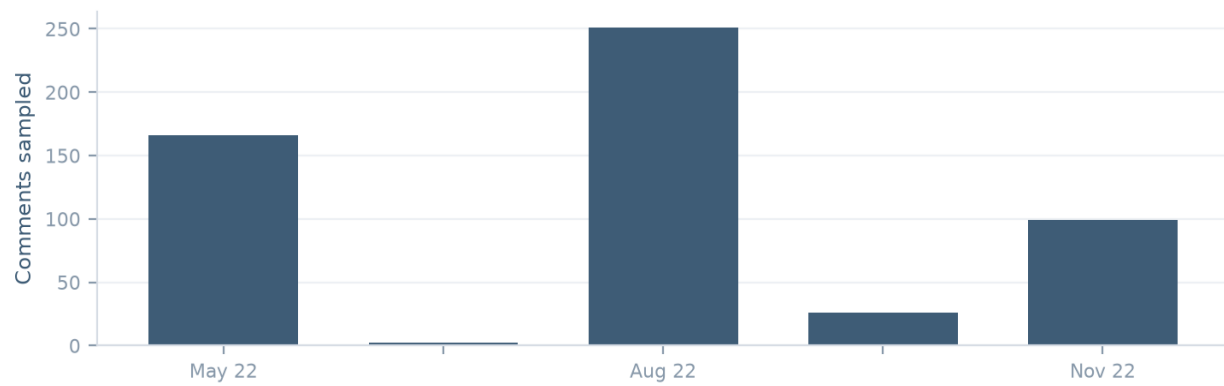
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

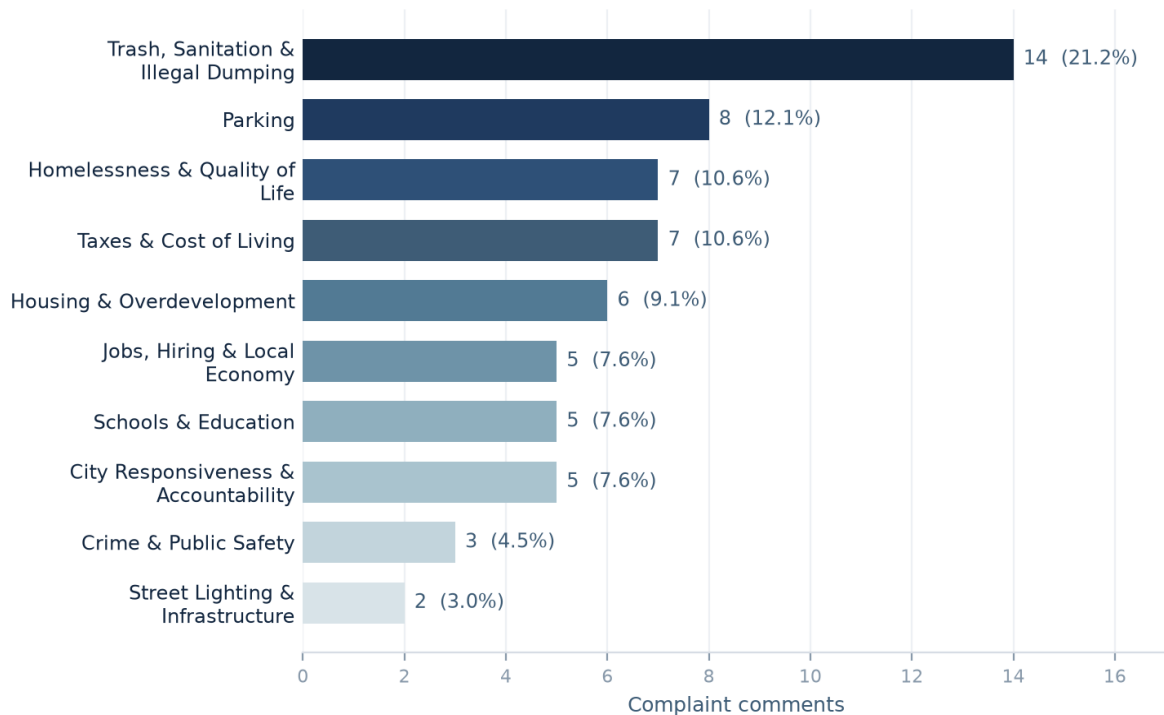
- Coverage for this window: 165 Facebook posts and 0 Instagram posts were sampled. Facebook's public feed is paged in date-bounded slices, so this is a sample of the period rather than every post the city published in it.
- This period is Facebook-only. The Instagram account's public feed could not be paged back past March 2023 - the crawl exhausted at 1,680 posts - so no Instagram comments exist for this window. Later periods draw on both platforms, which is worth remembering when comparing across reports.
- The city's pages drew far less engagement in this period than they do now - many posts carry no comments at all - so the complaint counts here are much smaller than in recent years. Compare shares between periods rather than raw counts.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts inside the window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it in this window. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 21.2% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping, Parking, Homelessness & Quality of Life — together make up 44% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

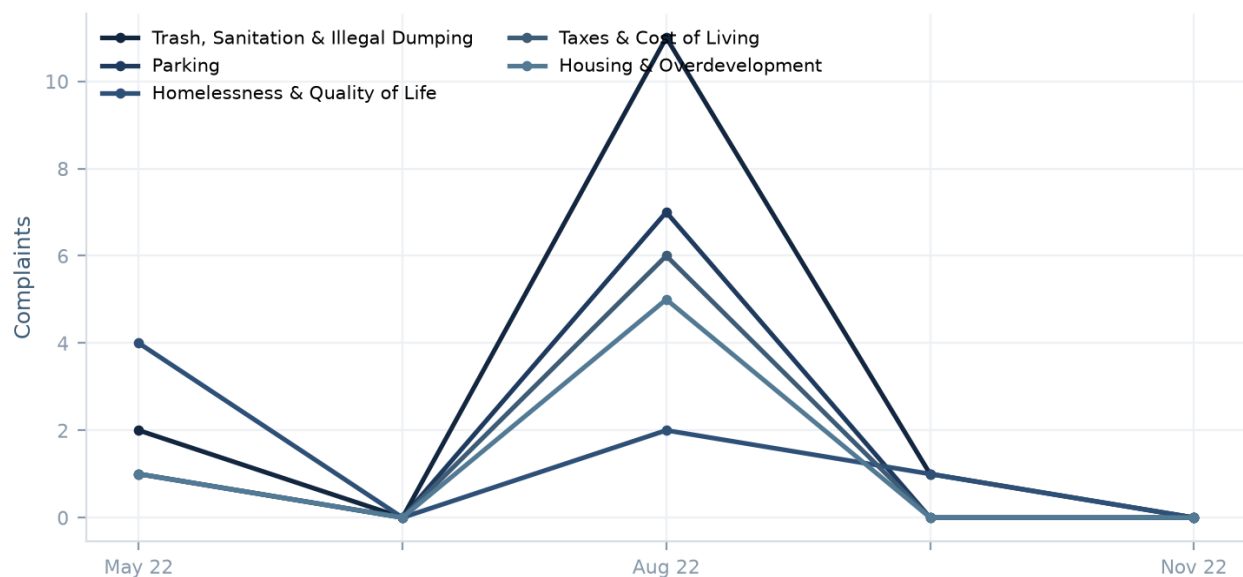


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	14	21.2%	1.4
2	Parking	8	12.1%	1.5
3	Homelessness & Quality of Life	7	10.6%	4.1
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	7	10.6%	6.3
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	6	9.1%	1.8
6	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	5	7.6%	0.8
7	Schools & Education	5	7.6%	3.8
8	City Responsiveness & Accountability	5	7.6%	5.6
9	Crime & Public Safety	3	4.5%	0.3
10	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	2	3.0%	0.0

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

14 complaints · 21.2% of all complaints · Facebook 14



"They are dumping garbage everywhere. Last week coming home I saw a stack of mattresses on central Avenue. Last year I saw on Facebook that someone dumped a truckload of used tires at a park in Yonkers. Really disgusting"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"Great now they have to place cameras there. Unfortunately this dumping problem is everywhere. Mr. Spano you have to change those rules at the sawmill River Road sanitation dump site. People from Yonkers are willing to bring garbage there but they don't let them because of those strick rules and regulations. People have no clue where else to dump so that's why they dump everywhere around yonkers."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

"Boats, jet skies, cars, stacks of tires, furniture and who knows what else. It's terrible that these people are allowed to get away with dumping. Than the tax payers foot the bill for sanitation to go clean up someone's mess! Funny my husband mentioned it wasn't westchester, that it was nyc."

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"Yes, now let's clean up Vredenburg. Calls are made and to no avail no action. Sidewalks overgrown with weeds that turned into trees."

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

2

Parking

8 complaints · 12.1% of all complaints · Facebook 8



"Also a lot of trucks parked there. They need to be towed so a sweeper can come by"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"And make the trailers stop parking there too. People are using them to hide what they are doing"

Facebook · 2022 · 5 likes · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"I was shocked a few weeks ago to see nothing but mountains of garbage on the south bound side. It looked like a dump had been created. How was this problem ignored for such a long time? Very unpleasant feeling to see this as a representation of Yonkers residents when it's truckers breaking the law on purpose to not pay parking in NYC."

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

"There is dumping all over Yonkers Streets. UnderCliff street is disgusting at times. People things it's there dumping grounds. Besides illegal parking. It's also a one way street at a certain point and people drive up it anyway."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

3

Homelessness & Quality of Life

7 complaints · 10.6% of all complaints · Facebook 7



"When I lived in Manhattan I had no idea how annoying leaf blowers would be until I moved to the suburbs! It's terrible noise pollution!■"

Facebook · 2022 · 11 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today announced the launch of the city's new electric leaf blower rebate ..."

"do something about the noisy delivery trucks w the vibrations and noise from there mufflers... why aren't they fined?"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Has anyone noticed our new 3rd Largest City banners all around our great city? ■ Fun fact..."

"What's next lawnmowers? Snowblowers? Street cleaners, which make more noise than anything? Why doesn't the city lead by example? Why is the city school system exempt? ■■"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today announced the launch of the city's new electric leaf blower rebate ..."

"Start with creating programs for people with mental health issues. Awareness is great but we need action. We need available psychologists and psychiatrists now."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "#MentalHealthAwarenessMonth ... Mayor Mike Spano's Health Advisory Board will be hostin..."

4

Taxes & Cost of Living

7 complaints · 10.6% of all complaints · Facebook 7



"Wonder how many tax breaks they were offered for the mere 25 "affordable apartments". Look what happened to brooklyn. They gave away all kinds of tax abatements and that money could have gone to fixing the streets, better funding for schools, all kinds of things."

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "This week, we broke ground of the future home of a 25-story residential building on the va..."

"Why give them the peoples tax money instead of buying it or building more schools"

Facebook · 2022 · 3 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano and the Yonkers Board of Education today announced the Board's approval t..."

"How about parking stickers for your tax payers so we can enjoy the waterfront"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "We're on our way to the top! ■ Yonkers' improvements driven by Mayor Mike Spano are like ..."

"25 out of 250 will be "affordable" .. what a joke. Affordable in Yonkers means 45 + a year.. Some of the best positions in yonkers don't even offer that much."

Facebook · 2022 · 27 likes · on: "This week, we broke ground of the future home of a 25-story residential building on the va..."

5

Housing & Overdevelopment

6 complaints · 9.1% of all complaints · Facebook 6



"Cozy for Ginsburg tenants paying \$3-5,000 For apartments??"

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "We take pride in Mayor Mike Spano and the city's efforts for bringing in luxury real estat..."

"I'm sure it'll end up being section 8 because no one will be able to afford it"

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "This week, we broke ground of the future home of a 25-story residential building on the va..."

6

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

5 complaints · 7.6% of all complaints · Facebook 5



"Really nice forecast for Yonkers. Nice job Mayor. ■ of course there is a list of things that need to be done and with time it will happen. Hopefully new and more money into yonkers will bring about better road and the other to do's."

Facebook · 2022 · 3 likes · on: "We're on our way to the top! ■ Yonkers' improvements driven by Mayor Mike Spano are like ..."

"Good job.. Please catch the people that dump there... Cameras seem to be working"

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "Job well done! ■■■■..."

"The 3rd precinct Dispatchers need mental health checks to straighten out their job priorities Nasty and cruel"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Tune in live!..."

"Monday is a depressing day for many especially those that are broke and their jobs don't pay enough or provide any incentives or medical benefits. I want to be a politician they get everything even a pension after a few years of service while sitting in air-conditioned office. How nice. And that doesn't include the under the table benefits."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "We know it's Miserable Monday but let's not think of it that way! ■ New Week ■ New Opport..."

7

Schools & Education

5 complaints · 7.6% of all complaints · Facebook 5



"Oh please. And you wonder a large number of Yonkers Public Schools HS teens have failed at least one class during the 2021-22 school year. Also many vehicles are illegally parked in Yonkers with illegal license plate covers to evade enforcement cameras. #LiberalLogic #Idiocy"

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "The New York State Office of Cannabis Management is hosting the "Get Ready, Get Set for Ca..."

"Heard Long Island school buses have cameras on them to take pictures of cars that don't stop for school buses."

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "Job well done! ■■■■..."

*"This is the absolute *last thing the city government should be promoting. Especially a week before school starts. No wonder Yonkers has the problems it does."*

Facebook · 2022 · 15 likes · on: "The New York State Office of Cannabis Management is hosting the "Get Ready, Get Set for Ca..."

"Check out, McLean Avenue across the street from school 13. SAD ■ TO SEE OUR CITY FALLING APART."

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

8

City Responsiveness & Accountability

5 complaints · 7.6% of all complaints · Facebook 5



"So, the city is trying to pass this off as affordable housing yet, sure magnitude of this project is lost on them. The building corruption built. Those grandstanding on what a wonderful job the Mayor has done are the minority. People are waking up as the corruption gets more bold. As one of my Moms famous sayings, "give them enough rope they will hang themselves." It's not if it's when."

Facebook · 2022 · 3 likes · on: "This week, we broke ground of the future home of a 25-story residential building on the va..."

"Outstanding!! This is great!! NYS will reimburse a large portion of the lease payment and we get a new school. This is a great concept that should be considered across all of our schools! We need more schools in our growing city. Well done, Mayor Mike Spano!"

Facebook · 2022 · 21 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano and the Yonkers Board of Education today announced the Board's approval t..."

"Finally Adams does something other than a photo op....."

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

"Mayor, this is all a lie and smoke screen!"

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "This week, we broke ground of the future home of a 25-story residential building on the va..."

9

Crime & Public Safety

3 complaints · 4.5% of all complaints · Facebook 3



"THC is not a gateway drug. It may save you from worst drugs that are huge gateways drugs like beer and liquor and others. you are less likely to drive stoned vs alcohol and more likely to stay home and watch netflix and pizza vs blowing ur money on a night out or driving drunk. for addiction THC is your savior, its the only drug that would keep you home vs going on a mission!!"

Facebook · 2022 · 1 likes · on: "The New York State Office of Cannabis Management is hosting the "Get Ready, Get Set for Ca..."

"YONKERS IS A PIT OF VIOLENCE AND THIRD WORLD MENTALITY"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "We take pride in Mayor Mike Spano and the city's efforts for bringing in luxury real estat..."

10

Street Lighting & Infrastructure

2 complaints · 3.0% of all complaints · Facebook 2



"And to help see in the dark maybe street lights should be fixed so they actually work. Also install new ones where there aren't like Agar St"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "It's nearly time to turn your clocks back an hour! ■ Daylight Saving Ends TOMORROW at 2AM..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	14	19	21.2%
2	Parking	8	14	12.1%
3	Homelessness & Quality of Life	7	7	10.6%
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	7	8	10.6%
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	6	9	9.1%
6	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	5	6	7.6%
7	Schools & Education	5	9	7.6%
8	City Responsiveness & Accountability	5	6	7.6%
9	Crime & Public Safety	3	3	4.5%
10	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	2	2	3.0%
11	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	2	2	3.0%
12	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	1	1	1.5%
13	Roads & Potholes	1	1	1.5%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.